

# DCAT-US 3.0 brief: ROWS

## The table's rows, in detail

Prepared 7 October 2026. For each statistical need: the answers the check confirmed, each with its sources, and the outcome the rule assigns.

### 1. series: outcome B

- **Asked for?** FCSM's Framework for Data Quality asks that documentation state the expected periodicity of a data product's production and the time frames it covers. [1]
- **Asked for?** FCSM's Framework for Data Quality asks agencies to tell data users the expected periodicity of production and the time frames available. [1]
- **Asked for?** FCSM's Framework for Data Quality calls for telling data users the expected periodicity of a data product's production. [1]
- **Asked for?** FCSM's Framework for Data Quality recommends documentation state the expected periodicity of a data product's production. [1]
- **Asked for?** FCSM notes OMB directives require agencies to publish annual release dates identifying reports as regular and recurring. [1]
- **Asked for?** FCSM notes OMB directives require agencies to publish annual release dates identifying reports as regular and recurring. [1]
- **Where it landed** The link marking a dataset as one release in a series was Optional in earlier drafts but no longer appears on the federal dataset page. [2][3][4]
- **What the standards say** Data Catalog Vocabulary version 3 makes series their own record type and links a dataset to its series with inSeries, which the current federal dataset page no longer lists. [2][3][5]

### 2. dimensions: outcome D

- **Asked for?** The Federal Committee on Statistical Methodology's transparent reporting paper tells reporters to describe the data's categorical variables, called dimensions, such as place, item and time. [6]
- **What the standards say** StatDCAT-AP, a statistical catalog profile, and the Data Cube vocabulary name each breakdown as its own field in the record, not in a written description of variables. [6][7][8]

### 3. units of measure: not placed: B or C or D or E

Why it is not placed: parts left unconfirmed by the check in both rounds: asked, literature.

- **Where it landed** Unit of measure is Optional, and it sits on the quality measurement class, giving the unit of a quality score rather than of the data itself. [9]

### 4. uncertainty: outcome B

- **Asked for?** The Federal Committee on Statistical Methodology's report on transparent reporting for integrated data quality says sampling and nonsampling errors need to be measured and documented. [6]
- **Where it landed** DCAT-US 3.0 lists hasQualityMeasurement, a measurement of a dataset against one quality measure such as accuracy, as Optional. [2][3]
- **What the standards say** The World Wide Web Consortium's Data Quality Vocabulary expresses precision and accuracy as quality measurements, the same Optional property DCAT-US 3.0 adopts for quality reporting. [2][3][10]

### 5. methodology and provenance: outcome D

- **Asked for?** The Federal Committee on Statistical Methodology's framework for data quality and its transparent reporting report ask documentation to give source data and the methods used to combine it. [1][6]
- **Where it landed** Statements of a dataset's history, the activity that generated it, its source, and documentation links are each Optional on the dataset page. [2][3]
- **What the standards say** The World Wide Web Consortium asks for origin and history a computer can process automatically, while the statistical side asked for written detail on the processing methods used. [1][11]

## 6. revisions and versions: not placed: B or D

Why it is not placed: parts left unconfirmed by the check in both rounds: literature.

- **Asked for?** FCSM 19-01's transparent reporting report calls for errors to be measured and documented and for revisions to be regularly analyzed. [6]
- **Asked for?** FCSM 25-03 on AI-ready federal statistical data asks agencies to return comprehensive metadata, including update timestamps, through their data product APIs. [12]
- **Asked for?** FCSM 25-03 on AI-ready federal statistical data recommends that high-value data products expose metadata recording when the data were updated. [12]
- **Asked for?** FCSM's AI-Ready Federal Statistical Data report calls for data product metadata that includes update timestamps reflecting when data was revised. [12]
- **Where it landed** The Data Catalog Vocabulary profile for the United States, DCAT-US 3.0, marks version, versionNotes, hasVersion, hasCurrentVersion, previousVersion and replaces Optional on its Dataset page. [2][3]

## 7. quality dimensions: outcome D

- **Asked for?** The Federal Committee on Statistical Methodology's 2025 paper says each data element should be assessed for quality on named aspects, called dimensions, such as timeliness and accuracy. [12]
- **Where it landed** In DCAT-US 3.0 the Dataset element hasQualityMeasurement is Optional, and it lists quality measurements for the dataset such as completeness, accuracy, or timeliness. [2][3]
- **What the standards say** The Data Quality Vocabulary, a web standard, offers a quality dimension class but no fixed dimension list, leaving the choice to publishers, unlike the statistical framework's named set. [1][5][10]

## 8. restricted-access terms: not placed: A or D

Why it is not placed: parts left unconfirmed by the check in both rounds: literature.

- **Asked for?** The Chief Data Officers Council data sharing report calls for an expedited data use agreement process governing the conditions of access to shared data. [13]
- **Asked for?** The CDO Council's data sharing report calls for establishing data use agreements that define how a party requests access to a dataset. [13]
- **Asked for?** FCSM working paper 19-01 on transparent reporting adopts accessibility as reporting the conditions under which users obtain data, including where to go and how to order. [6]
- **Asked for?** The FCSM data quality case studies report lists procedures and practices surrounding access, plus time from application to receipt, among the things to document for users. [14]
- **Asked for?** FCSM's Framework for Data Quality describes special arrangements, such as Research Data Centers, by which users apply for access to restricted-use data. [1]
- **Asked for?** The FCSM Framework for Data Quality states that confidential information compiled for official statistics should be used only for statistical purposes, a condition limiting dataset use. [1]
- **Asked for?** The FCSM Framework for Data Quality notes agencies may establish special user access provisions for datasets under accessibility. [1]
- **Where it landed** Separate structured fields for access limits, use limits and controlled unclassified information limits are Recommended, and the rights field is also Recommended. [2][3][15]

## Sources

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